

Roasted Butternut Squash Soup (Variation 16)

Tags: soup, vegan, gluten-free, autumn, healthy | Prep: 20 min | Cook: 50 min | Serves: 6

Ingredients

- 1.5 kg butternut squash, halved lengthways and seeds removed
- 1 large onion, quartered
- 1 head of garlic, halved crosswise
- 3 tbsp olive oil
- Salt and black pepper
- 1 tsp ground cumin
- 1/2 tsp ground coriander
- 1/4 tsp cayenne pepper
- 1 litre vegetable stock
- 400 ml coconut milk
- Juice of 1 lime
- Toasted pumpkin seeds and chilli oil to serve

Method

1. Preheat oven to 200 °C. Line a large roasting tray with baking paper.
2. Place squash cut-side up, along with onion and garlic on the tray. Drizzle with 2 tbsp oil, season with salt and pepper.
3. Roast for 40–45 minutes until squash is completely tender and caramelised at the edges.
4. Allow to cool slightly. Scoop squash flesh from the skin. Squeeze garlic from its papery skin.
5. Heat remaining 1 tbsp oil in a large pot over medium heat. Add cumin, coriander, and cayenne; cook 30 seconds.
6. Add roasted squash, onion, and garlic to the pot. Pour in stock and coconut milk.
7. Blend until completely smooth using an immersion blender (or in batches in a standing blender).
8. Reheat gently, adding more stock if too thick. Add lime juice, taste, and season.
9. Serve topped with toasted pumpkin seeds and a drizzle of chilli oil.

Chef Tips

- Roasting the vegetables concentrates their natural sugars — do not shortcut this step by steaming.
- When blending hot liquids in a standing blender, fill only halfway and hold the lid with a folded tea towel.
- Soup keeps refrigerated for 5 days and freezes for 3 months.